Installing Abbrevio

A step-by-step walkthrough for the installer and the Portable Edition (version 1.0.0)

Abbrevio is a text expander for Windows: type a short keyword and it is replaced with the longer text you've saved. It comes in two editions. Both have the same features. They differ in where Abbrevio and your data are kept.

Which edition should I use?

	Installer (.exe)	Portable Edition (.zip)
Best for	Your own computer, used every day	USB drives, shared or locked-down computers
Installs into Windows	Yes, into `C:\Program Files\Abbrevio`	No. Runs from any folder you choose
Admin rights	Usually needed to install	Not needed
Start menu shortcut	Yes	No
Start automatically at login	Optional (in Preferences)	Not available
Where your combos and settings live	Your Windows user profile	A `Data` folder next to `Abbrevio.exe`
Updates	Downloaded and installed for you	Opens the download page; you replace the files

Where to download

Download Abbrevio only from the official releases page:
https://github.com/CanScribe-College/Abbrevio/releases

Under **Assets** on the latest release, you'll find:

- `Abbrevio-1.0.0-Installer.exe`: the installer
- `Abbrevio-1.0.0-PortableEdition.zip`: the Portable Edition

> **System requirements:** 64-bit Windows. Abbrevio is built for x64 only.

Part A: Install with the installer

Use this if Abbrevio should be installed on this computer, appear in the Start menu, and keep itself up to date.

1 **Download the installer**
On the releases page, click `Abbrevio-1.0.0-Installer.exe` under **Assets**. Save it, for example to your **Downloads** folder.

2 **Run the installer**
Double-click the downloaded file.
If Windows shows **"Windows protected your PC"** (SmartScreen), click **More info** and then **Run anyway**. Only do this for a file you downloaded from the official releases page.
If Windows asks **"Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?"**, click **Yes**. Installing into Program Files needs administrator rights.

3 **Remove an older version (upgrades only)**
If an earlier version of Abbrevio is already installed, you'll see: *"Before you can install Abbrevio, you must uninstall the version that is currently installed on your computer."*
Click **Yes** and follow the uninstaller. Your combos and preferences are kept. Clicking **No** cancels the installation.

4 **Welcome page**
Click **Next**.

5 **License agreement**
Read the license terms, then click **I Agree** to continue.

6 **Choose the install location**
The default is `C:\Program Files\Abbrevio`. If you're upgrading, the installer suggests the folder you used before. Leave it as is unless you need a different folder, then click **Install**.

7 **Finish**
When the files have been copied, the last page has a **Run Abbrevio** checkbox. Leave it ticked to start Abbrevio right away, then click **Finish**.

After installing

8 **Find Abbrevio in the notification area**
Abbrevio runs in the background. Its icon is in the notification area at the right of the taskbar. Click the **^** arrow if you don't see it.
Click the icon to open the main window. Right-click it for the menu, which includes **Exit Abbrevio**.
You can also start Abbrevio from **Start** → **Abbrevio** → **Abbrevio**.

9 **Optional: start Abbrevio when you sign in**
Open **Preferences**, go to the **Behavior** section, and tick **Automatically start Abbrevio at login**. It's off by default.

Updating

Abbrevio checks the releases page for new versions. When one is available, a window shows the release notes and these buttons:

- **Install**: downloads the new installer, checks that it isn't corrupted, then closes Abbrevio and starts the installer. Follow steps 2 to 7 above.
- **Not now**: asks again later.
- **Skip this version**: doesn't offer this version again.

To check by hand, open **Preferences** → **Behavior** and click **Check now**.

Uninstalling

Use either of these:

- **Start** → **Abbrevio** → **Uninstall Abbrevio**
- **Settings** → **Apps** → **Installed apps**, find **Abbrevio**, then click **⋯** → **Uninstall**

> **Note:** The uninstaller removes the program files and shortcuts but leaves your combos and preferences, so reinstalling picks up where you left off. If you want to move to another computer, use **Advanced** → **Back Up** first. This creates an `.abrbackup` file you can restore with **Advanced** → **Restore**.

Part B: Use the Portable Edition

The Portable Edition needs no installation. Unzip it into any folder, including a USB drive, and run it. Everything Abbrevio saves stays inside that folder.

1. **Download the zip file**
   On the releases page, click `Abbrevio-1.0.0-PortableEdition.zip` under **Assets** and save it.

2. **Extract the zip**
   Right-click the downloaded zip and choose **Extract All...**
   Choose where Abbrevio should live, such as a folder in **Documents** or the root of a USB drive. Then click **Extract**.

> **Important:** Don't run Abbrevio from inside the zip file without extracting it first. Windows would run it from a temporary folder, and your combos could be lost.

3. **Open the Abbrevio folder**
   The extracted files are in a folder named `AbbrevioPortableEdition`. Inside you'll find `Abbrevio.exe` with its support files, plus a small file called `Portable.bin`.

4. **Start Abbrevio**
   Double-click **Abbrevio.exe**. If SmartScreen appears, click **More info** → **Run anyway**.
   The window title reads **Abbrevio - Portable Edition**, so you can tell which edition is running. As with the installed version, Abbrevio runs from the notification area.

5. **Your data folder**
   On first launch, Abbrevio creates a `Data` folder next to `Abbrevio.exe`. It holds your combos, your preferences (`Settings.ini`), backups and the log file. Copy the whole `AbbrevioPortableEdition` folder to take Abbrevio and all your combos to another computer.

> **Keep Portable.bin:** This file tells Abbrevio to run in portable mode. If you delete it, Abbrevio stops using the `Data` folder and stores everything in your Windows user profile instead.

What's different in the Portable Edition

- There's no **Automatically start Abbrevio at login** option. Start it yourself when you need it.
- The combo list is always stored in the `Data` folder, so it can't be moved to a different folder.
- No Start menu shortcut or entry in **Installed apps** is created.

Updating the Portable Edition

When a new version is available, the update window has a **Download Page** button instead of **Install**. It opens the releases page in your browser. To update:

1. **Close Abbrevio**
   Right-click the notification area icon and choose **Exit Abbrevio**.

2. **Extract the new version to a new folder**
   Download the new zip and extract it next to the old folder. Don't extract it over the old one.

3. **Bring your data across**
   Copy the `Data` folder from the old `AbbrevioPortableEdition` folder into the new one. Then start the new `Abbrevio.exe` and check that your combos are there. After that you can delete the old folder.

Removing the Portable Edition

Exit Abbrevio, then delete the folder. Nothing else was installed on the computer. If you might want your combos later, keep a copy of the **Data** folder or make a backup first with **Advanced** → **Back Up**.

Getting help

In Abbrevio, the **Help** menu links to **Getting Started**, the **Abbrevio Wiki** and **Report Bug**. These open the project's GitHub pages at github.com/CanScribe-College/Abbrevio.